



Figure 6: Adding a soundtrack

Step 6: How about adding a soundtrack? This could be a narration you've recorded, or just a music file. Click on the **Soundtrack** tab and then on the **Import** button (Figure 6). Choose your track from the navigation window that opens. There are even sound effect options like fading in and fading out, and volume control. Further, even though the length of the soundtrack could be more than the slide show's length, Manslide will adjust the track length to the slide show's length, automatically.

Step 7: And finally... I can't wait any longer for my own slide show video! Click on the **Export** button. Enter the name of your project in the slide show title field and the type of codec (MPEG2, XVID, DV or Flash) from the drop down menu. You can also select the video quality (high, standard or low) for your project. Refer to Figure 7.

When all is done, click on the **Start** button and find your masterpiece in the destination folder that you selected at the start of your project. The creation time depends on the number of slides and video quality chosen.

Note: On the vertical pane on the right hand side of Manslide are controls to orient your slides in X, Y or Z direction. Also available are two flags to start and stop animations. To use the effect of these flags in your slide, click on one or more of the X, Y or Z buttons, and then click on the **Start** flag. Right



Figure 7: The Export button

click on your slide and hold the mouse button down to change the orientation of the slide. Once done, click on the **Stop** flag.

If at any time you wish to stop your unfinished work, click on **Project**→**Save Project**. The saved file will have extension **.msz**. To continue sometime later, run Manslide again and navigate to **Project**→**Open existing project**.

Caution: Manslide is not verbose as far as reporting missing dependencies is concerned. On installing Manslide from the Mandriva Spring DVD, I found that **netpbm** and **smilutil** were not installed, which resulted in the final video slide show not being created. However, on installing the required dependencies, all problems were solved.

The final touch

I only have one word to define this masterpiece of an application: Fantastic! Time to call over my friends who're still stuck to their Windows for some tea and cookies (my grandma's masterpiece), with the secret intention of playing them my masterpiece video. After all, it's Windows' envy, Linux's pride. **END**

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